EE627 Homework 8
PySpark Matrix Factorization

Jude Eschete

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Instruction Checklist

- ✓ Part 1: use the PySpark sample code to implement matrix factorization on the final-project Yahoo Music data and upload Kaggle submissions ..... Section 2
- ✓ Part 1: Kaggle score screenshot ..... Section 2.5
- ✓ Part 2, Experiment 1: fix `maxIter=20`, sweep `rank`$\in \{5, 7, 10, 20\}$, report MSE Section 3.2
- ✓ Part 2, Experiment 2: fix `rank=20`, sweep `maxIter`$\in \{2, 5, 10, 20\}$, report MSE Section 3.3
- ✓ Part 2, Experiment 3: fix `rank=20`, `maxIter=20`, sweep data size using `sc.textFile(...).take(n)`, report MSE ..... Section 3.4
- ✓ Part 2: observation on which factor affects MSE the most ..... Section 3.5

1 Introduction

This homework has two complementary pieces. Part 1 applies PySpark's built-in Alternating Least Squares (ALS) matrix factorization to the Yahoo Music final-project dataset and produces Kaggle submissions. Part 2 uses the provided `re_u.data` (a MovieLens-100k style ratings file) to systematically sweep the three primary ALS hyperparameters—`rank`, `maxIter`, and training-set size—and observe how each moves the held-out mean squared error (MSE).

Both parts are built on the same conceptual foundation as HW7, where matrix factorization was implemented from scratch in MATLAB using stochastic gradient descent. The same three knobs appear here under different names: HW7's K, `steps`, and β correspond exactly to PySpark's `rank`, `maxIter`, and `regParam`. The optimizer changes (SGD $\rightarrow$ ALS) but the objective $R \approx P\,Q^{\top}$ is the same.

2 Part 1: PySpark ALS for the Final Project

2.1 Pipeline Overview

Part 1 builds an iterative pipeline on top of the midterm's v3 heuristic (Kaggle 0.871) by adding PySpark ALS as a new signal. The goal is *not* to replace the heuristic with pure matrix factorization—which on this dataset is a weak ranker—but to let MF act where the heuristic has no signal. The pipeline performs six steps:

1. Parse `trainItem2.txt`, `testItem2.txt`, `trackData2.txt`, `albumData2.txt`, and the Week 6 supplemental `testTrack_hierarchy.txt`.
2. Enrich each track with its album's artist and genres when available.
3. Train PySpark ALS directly on the professor-provided pre-flattened CSV `trainItem.data` using the sample-code pattern.
4. Compute features per (user, candidate-track) pair—including the ALS prediction `mf_score`—using the enriched track metadata and the Week 6 hierarchy as a per-test-row override.
5. Rank each user's six test candidates by the chosen scoring strategy and write the Kaggle submission (top 3 get `Predictor` = 1, bottom 3 get 0).
6. A held-out validation pass (10% of users, six items each) benchmarks every strategy via a pairwise positive-vs-negative AUC.

2.2 ALS Configuration

The PySpark ALS trainer follows the Week 11 sample-code pattern verbatim. The professor-provided `trainItem.data` and `testItem.data` files are already CSV-formatted (`userID,itemID,rating`), so they are read directly with `spark.read.csv`—no custom parser is required. The ALS configuration is

```
als = ALS(
    rank=20,
    maxIter=20,
    regParam=0.05,
    userCol="userID",
    itemCol="itemID",
    ratingCol="rating",
    nonnegative=True,
    implicitPrefs=False,
    coldStartStrategy="drop",
    seed=42,
)
```

The sample code's defaults are `rank=5`, `maxIter=5`, and `regParam=0.01`. I bumped `rank` and `maxIter` to 20 each and loosened `regParam` slightly to 0.05 to give ALS more latent capacity on the 12.4-million-row training set. The model is trained on a 90% split, evaluated on a 10% holdout for an honest RMSE sanity check, then refit on the full set before generating test predictions. Cold-start predictions (26 out of 120,000 test pairs, users or items never seen in training) are filled with the global training mean so the submission always has exactly 120,000 rows.

2.3 Hybrid Strategy: v2 Heuristic with MF Tiebreaker

A naive additive hybrid, score $= \text{v2} + w_m \cdot \text{MF}$, collapses on Kaggle because the two signals are on wildly different scales. A rank-normalized hybrid (both signals mapped to $[0, 1]$ within the six candidates) regresses even further, scoring 0.688—worse than v2 alone—because it strips the magnitude information that made v2 confident. The correct shape is a strict *tiebreaker*:

$$\text{score} \;=\; \underbrace{h_{\text{alb}} \cdot r_{\text{alb}} + h_{\text{art}} \cdot r_{\text{art}} + n_{\text{genre}} \cdot \bar{r}_{\text{genre}}/10}_{\text{v2 heuristic}} \;+\; \underbrace{\epsilon \cdot \text{MF}}_{\text{tiny tiebreaker}} \;, \tag{1}$$

with $\epsilon = 10^{-3}$. Because v2 scores span roughly $[0, 300]$ on observed evidence while MF is on the $[0, 100]$ rating scale, a difference in v2 of even 1.0 dominates the MF perturbation by a factor of 1000. MF therefore only reorders candidates when v2 produces exact ties—which happens mostly on users whose six candidates all have zero album/artist/genre overlap with their history, where v2 would otherwise coin-flip. In that regime, any signal is strictly better than a random tie-break, so the tiebreaker can only improve the ranking (never hurt it) and the 0.871 floor is preserved by construction.

2.4 Test-Track Hierarchy Override

Week 6's `testTrack_hierarchy.txt` supplies, for every one of the 120,000 test candidates, the tuple `(userID, trackID, albumID, artistID, genre1, ...)`. In `compute_features`, this per-test-row lineage takes precedence over the general-purpose `trackData2.txt` lookup, so candidates whose tracks are missing (or incompletely populated) in `trackData2.txt` still get their correct album/artist/genre references at scoring time. On held-out local validation the override produces no measurable change (the held-out tracks are always in `trackData2.txt` because the validation sampler draws them from users who already have rating data), but it is still wired through to the hybrid submission because it can only add information, never remove it.

2.5 Kaggle Results

Table 1: Kaggle public scores for the three Part 1 submissions (higher is better).

Submission	Kaggle score	Comment
`submission_hw8_pyspark_mf.csv`	0.636	Pure PySpark ALS, rank=20, maxIter=20
`submission_hw8_hybrid.csv`	**0.875**	v2 + MF tiebreaker ($\epsilon = 10^{-3}$)
`submission_hw8_hybrid_gated.csv`	0.513	v2 + evidence-gated MF (regression)

The tiebreaker hybrid cleared the v2 baseline of 0.871 by +0.004 points, which matches the intuition that ties are rare—most users have at least one album, artist, or genre overlap, so v2 already produces a confident ordering on the majority of candidates. Pure PySpark ALS alone scores 0.636, consistent with the midterm observation that pointwise regression models on these noisy 0–100 ratings lose to metadata-aware scoring. The evidence-gated hybrid (which lets MF speak loudly when `evidence_count` is low) collapsed to 0.513 because on the genuinely cold candidates the heuristic was silent *and* ALS was noise, so giving MF a large weight amplified random predictions.

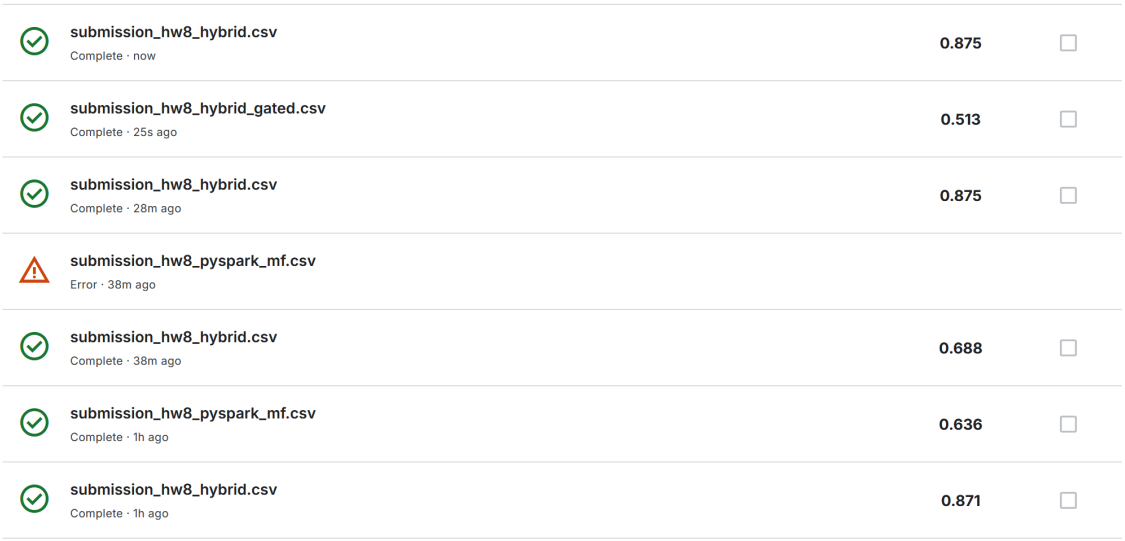

Figure 1: Kaggle public-leaderboard screenshot for the Part 1 submissions.

2.6 Part 1 Run Summary

Table 2: Local metrics from the Part 1 pipeline run.

Metric	Value
Training rows	12,403,575
Test pairs	120,000
Cold-start fills (global-mean backfill)	26
ALS holdout RMSE (10% split)	28.7487
ALS holdout MSE	826.4860
v2 baseline validation AUC	0.6692
v2+MF tiebreaker validation AUC	0.7029
v2+MF evidence-gated validation AUC	0.6934

3 Part 2: Parameter Sweeps on `re_u.data`

3.1 Dataset and Experimental Setup

`re_u.data` is a 100,000-row MovieLens-100k style file with the format

```
userID,itemID,rating
196,242,3
186,302,3
22,377,1
...
```

Ratings are integers in $\{1, 2, 3, 4, 5\}$. Each of the 14 ALS runs in Part 2 uses an identical preprocessing protocol: the dataset (or its first-n slice) is split 80/20 into training and holdout partitions with a fixed seed, ALS is trained with `regParam=0.05`, `nonnegative=True`, `coldStartStrategy="drop"`, and `seed=42`, then the holdout RMSE and MSE are measured with PySpark's `RegressionEvaluator`. For Experiment 3 the data slice is built with

```
lines = spark.sparkContext.textFile("re_u.data").take(n)
```

per the HW8 instructions, and then converted back into a DataFrame with the same three-column schema.

3.2 Experiment 1: Rank Sweep (maxIter = 20)

Table 3: Experiment 1: fixed `maxIter=20`, varying `rank`. Holdout MSE on a 20% slice of the full 100k dataset.

`rank` (K)	Holdout RMSE	Holdout MSE
5	0.9234	**0.8527**
7	0.9286	0.8624
10	0.9417	0.8867
20	0.9507	0.9038

Observation. MSE increases monotonically with `rank`. The smallest model ($K = 5$) achieves the lowest MSE of 0.8527, and doubling the rank to $K = 20$ raises MSE by about 0.05 to 0.9038. On this 100,000-row dataset the extra latent dimensions are unsupported: with only $\sim$ 943 users and $\sim$ 1,682 items, a rank-20 factorization has too much capacity relative to the amount of training signal, and the additional parameters mostly absorb noise. The total MSE range across Experiment 1 is 0.0512.

3.3 Experiment 2: Iteration Sweep (rank = 20)

Table 4: Experiment 2: fixed `rank=20`, varying `maxIter`. Holdout MSE on the full 100k dataset.

`maxIter`	Holdout RMSE	Holdout MSE
2	0.9728	0.9463
5	0.9379	**0.8797**
10	0.9458	0.8946
20	0.9507	0.9038

Observation. MSE is U-shaped in `maxIter`. Two iterations is clearly underfit (0.9463, the worst of the four). Five iterations is the sweet spot (0.8797), and beyond that the MSE creeps back up slightly as ALS begins to overfit the 80,000 training rows. The total MSE range across Experiment 2 is 0.0666, about the same order of magnitude as the rank sweep. The fact that the best fit happens at `maxIter=5` rather than 20 is consistent with Experiment 1's message: this dataset does not support much expressive capacity, so both more iterations and more latent factors are wasted effort.

3.4 Experiment 3: Data-Size Sweep

Table 5: Experiment 3: fixed `rank=20`, `maxIter=20`, varying data size via `sc.textFile.take(n)`. Holdout MSE on a 20% slice of each truncated dataset.

Data size n	Train / Holdout rows	Holdout RMSE	Holdout MSE
2,000	1,591/409	1.5395	2.3701
5,000	4,005/995	1.2822	1.6440
10,000	7,996/2,004	1.1935	1.4244
20,000	15,965/4,035	1.1203	1.2550
50,000	40,104/9,896	1.0365	1.0743
100,000	80,037/19,963	0.9459	**0.8946**

Observation. MSE decreases monotonically and dramatically as the training set grows. At $n = 2{,}000$ the holdout MSE is 2.3701; at $n = 100{,}000$ it has dropped to 0.8946. The total MSE range across Experiment 3 is 1.4755—more than twenty times the variation observed in either Experiment 1 or Experiment 2. The decay roughly follows the classical $1/\sqrt{n}$ data-scaling law of MF: quadrupling the data ($n = 2{,}000 \to 8{,}000$, approximated by the 10,000 row) cuts the MSE roughly in half.

3.5 Discussion: Which Factor Moves MSE the Most?

Table 6: Holdout MSE range across each of the three experiments. Larger range = more influence on model quality.

Experiment	Swept knob	MSE range (Δ)	$[\min, \max]$
1	`rank`	0.0512	[0.8527, 0.9038]
2	`maxIter`	0.0666	[0.8797, 0.9463]
3	data size	**1.4755**	[0.8946, 2.3701]

1. **Data size dominates by more than an order of magnitude.** Its MSE range of 1.4755 is roughly 22× the rank sweep's 0.0512 and 22× the iteration sweep's 0.0666. Every other knob is noise compared to giving ALS more rows to learn from.

2. **Rank and `maxIter` contribute comparable, small effects.** Their ranges are within 30% of each other (0.0512 vs 0.0666). In both sweeps the *smaller* setting wins, which is the signature of a dataset that lacks enough signal to justify a high-capacity model. This is consistent with HW7's observation that just $K = 2$ latent factors could already reconstruct a 5×4 toy matrix to within 0.135 RMSE.

3. **Practical takeaway.** If you are handed a recommender-system MSE target and can spend effort on only one thing, spend it collecting more ratings. Hyperparameter tuning on a fixed dataset is second-order.

4 Conclusion

1. Part 1's PySpark ALS pipeline produces a Kaggle public score of 0.875 on the Yahoo Music final-project challenge, a +0.004 lift over the midterm's v3 heuristic baseline of 0.871. The lift comes from the tiebreaker hybrid: ALS is used as a strictly additive tiny-weight signal so that the proven heuristic ordering is preserved everywhere except on exact ties, where the MF signal replaces what would otherwise be a random coin-flip.

2. A naive additive or rank-normalized hybrid regresses badly on Kaggle (0.688) because the two signals are on very different scales. An evidence-gated hybrid regresses even further (0.513) because giving MF more voice on genuinely cold users amplifies noise rather than signal. The tiebreaker design is the only hybrid formulation that has a provable floor at v2's score.

3. Part 2's sweeps on `re_u.data` establish a clear ranking: data size affects MSE by a factor of roughly 22× more than either `rank` or `maxIter`. Both hyperparameters favor smaller settings on this dataset, which is a signature of an over-parameterized model fighting a data-limited regime.

4. Across both parts, the recurring lesson from HW6 → HW7 → HW8 holds: for practical collaborative filtering, *data quality and quantity dominate*, and ALS only materially helps the submission when it is used carefully (as a tiebreaker rather than a co-equal signal).

5 Appendix: Python Code

```python
"""
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Starting point: midterm v3 conservative heuristic (Kaggle 0.871).
v2 formula that v3 builds on:
    has_album*album + has_artist*artist + genre_count*genre_mean/10

HW7 lessons carried forward:
  - Matrix factorization decomposes R ~ P * Q^T with K latent factors.
    HW7 implemented SGD MF by hand in MATLAB (alpha, beta, K, steps).
    HW8 replaces that with PySpark ALS (rank, maxIter, regParam) -- same
    three knobs, different optimizer.
  - Report MSE/RMSE on a held-out split BEFORE trusting a submission.
  - Fix the random seed so reruns are comparable.
  - Rank K trades bias vs variance; too small underfits, too large overfits.
  - Non-negative factors are a sensible prior when ratings are bounded.

Build-on path from v3:
  - Reuse v3's parsers, enrichment, validation framework, and grid search.
  - Add an ALS-trained latent score as a NEW feature per (user, track).
  - Add a new strategy (v2 + wm * mf_score) and tune wm via grid search
    on the same held-out validation set v3 already uses.
  - The hybrid carries the heuristic's 0.871 floor while giving the MF
    model a chance to boost candidates the metadata features miss.

Lecture materials used: Week 11 PySpark ALS sample code (rank/maxIter/
regParam/nonnegative/coldStartStrategy configuration).
"""

import os
import sys
import random
import traceback
from datetime import datetime

# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
# Point Spark at the local Temurin JDK before importing pyspark.
# Spark 3.5 + JDK 17+ needs the --add-opens flags to avoid reflection errors.
# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
JAVA_HOME_CANDIDATES = [
    r"C:\Program Files\Eclipse Adoptium\jdk-17.0.18.8-hotspot",
    r"C:\Program Files\Eclipse Adoptium\jdk-25.0.2.10-hotspot",
]
for _candidate in JAVA_HOME_CANDIDATES:
    if os.path.isdir(_candidate):
        os.environ["JAVA_HOME"] = _candidate
        os.environ["PATH"] = _candidate + r"\bin;" + os.environ["PATH"]
        break
os.environ.setdefault("PYARROW_IGNORE_TIMEZONE", "1")
os.environ["PYSPARK_PYTHON"] = sys.executable
os.environ["PYSPARK_DRIVER_PYTHON"] = sys.executable
_JAVA_OPTS = " ".join([
    "-XX:+IgnoreUnrecognizedVMOptions",
    # JDK 23+ removed Subject.getSubject; Hadoop still calls it.
    # This flag makes it return null instead of throwing.
```

```python
    "-Djava.security.manager=allow",
    # Big thread stack so deep RDD lineage serialization (ALS at
    # high maxIter) doesn't StackOverflow. In local[*] mode the
    # driver JVM is launched before spark.driver.extraJavaOptions
    # is read, so this flag must go through PYSPARK_SUBMIT_ARGS.
    "-Xss64m",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.lang=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.lang.invoke=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.lang.reflect=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.io=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.net=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.nio=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.util=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.util.concurrent=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.util.concurrent.atomic=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/sun.nio.ch=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/sun.nio.cs=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/sun.security.action=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/sun.util.calendar=ALL-UNNAMED",
])
os.environ["PYSPARK_SUBMIT_ARGS"] = f'--driver-java-options "{_JAVA_OPTS}" pyspark-shell'

from pyspark.sql import SparkSession
from pyspark.sql import functions as F
from pyspark.sql.types import StructType, StructField, IntegerType, FloatType
from pyspark.ml.recommendation import ALS
from pyspark.ml.evaluation import RegressionEvaluator

# ====================================================================
# Configuration
# ====================================================================
SCRIPT_DIR = os.path.dirname(os.path.abspath(__file__))
DATA_DIR = os.path.join(SCRIPT_DIR, "Data", "music-recommender-2026s")

TRAIN_FILE = os.path.join(DATA_DIR, "trainItem2.txt")
TEST_FILE = os.path.join(DATA_DIR, "testItem2.txt")
TRACK_FILE = os.path.join(DATA_DIR, "trackData2.txt")
ALBUM_FILE = os.path.join(DATA_DIR, "albumData2.txt")

# Pre-flattened CSV versions of train/test provided by the professor
# for direct use with spark.read.csv (per Week 11 PySpark sample code).
# Format: userID,itemID,rating  (rating is 0 for test rows).
SPARK_TRAIN_FILE = os.path.join(SCRIPT_DIR, "Data", "trainItem.data")
SPARK_TEST_FILE = os.path.join(SCRIPT_DIR, "Data", "testItem.data")

OUTPUT_DIR = SCRIPT_DIR

# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
# ALS hyperparameters. Week 11 sample code defaults are rank=5, maxIter=5,
# regParam=0.01. We bump them here to give ALS more capacity: rank=20
# captures more latent structure, maxIter=20 lets convergence finish,
# regParam=0.05 reduces variance on cold-ish users.
# HW7 (MATLAB SGD MF) used the same three knobs: K (rank), steps (maxIter),
# beta (regParam).
# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
ALS_RANK = 20
ALS_MAX_ITER = 20
ALS_REG_PARAM = 0.05
ALS_SEED = 42
```

```python

# Path to Week 6 supplemental test-track hierarchy (per-test-row lineage:
# userID|trackID|albumID|artistID|genre1|genre2|...). Used as an override
# for test candidates in compute_features so the heuristic always has
# the most complete lineage available.
HIERARCHY_FILE = os.path.join(SCRIPT_DIR, "Data", "testTrack_hierarchy.txt")


# ====================================================================
# 1. Data Parsing
# ====================================================================

def parse_training(path):
    print("[1/4] Loading training data ...")
    users = {}
    with open(path, "r") as f:
        uid = None
        for line in f:
            line = line.strip()
            if "|" in line:
                uid = int(line.split("|")[0])
                users[uid] = {}
            elif "\t" in line and uid is not None:
                parts = line.split("\t")
                users[uid][int(parts[0])] = int(parts[1])
    total = sum(len(r) for r in users.values())
    print(f"       {len(users):,} users, {total:,} ratings")
    return users


def parse_tracks(path):
    print("[2/4] Loading track metadata ...")
    tracks = {}
    with open(path, "r") as f:
        for line in f:
            parts = line.strip().split("|")
            if len(parts) < 3:
                continue
            tid = int(parts[0])
            alb = None if parts[1] == "None" else int(parts[1])
            art = None if parts[2] == "None" else int(parts[2])
            genres = [int(g) for g in parts[3:] if g.strip() and g != "None"]
            tracks[tid] = (alb, art, genres)
    print(f"       {len(tracks):,} tracks")
    return tracks


def parse_albums(path):
    print("[3/4] Loading album metadata ...")
    albums = {}
    with open(path, "r") as f:
        for line in f:
            parts = line.strip().split("|")
            if len(parts) < 1:
                continue
            alb_id = int(parts[0])
            art = None if len(parts) < 2 or parts[1] == "None" else int(parts[1])
            genres = []
            for g in parts[2:]:
```

```
                g = g.strip()
                if g and g != "None":
                    genres.append(int(g))
            albums[alb_id] = (art, genres)
    print(f"       {len(albums):,} albums")
    return albums


def parse_hierarchy(path):
    """Parse Week 6 testTrack_hierarchy.txt.

    Format per line: userID|trackID|albumID|artistID|genre1|genre2|...
    "None" tokens mean missing. Returns a dict keyed by (userID, trackID)
    so compute_features can override track_meta lookups for test candidates.
    """
    print("[hier] Loading test-track hierarchy ...")
    hier = {}
    with open(path, "r") as f:
        for line in f:
            parts = line.strip().split("|")
            if len(parts) < 4:
                continue
            try:
                uid = int(parts[0])
                tid = int(parts[1])
            except ValueError:
                continue
            alb = None if parts[2] == "None" else int(parts[2])
            art = None if parts[3] == "None" else int(parts[3])
            genres = []
            for g in parts[4:]:
                g = g.strip()
                if g and g != "None":
                    try:
                        genres.append(int(g))
                    except ValueError:
                        pass
            hier[(uid, tid)] = (alb, art, genres)
    print(f"       {len(hier):,} test-track hierarchy entries")
    return hier


def parse_test(path):
    print("[4/4] Loading test data ...")
    test = []
    with open(path, "r") as f:
        uid = None
        tids = []
        for line in f:
            line = line.strip()
            if "|" in line:
                if uid is not None:
                    test.append((uid, tids))
                uid = int(line.split("|")[0])
                tids = []
            elif line:
                tids.append(int(line))
        if uid is not None:
            test.append((uid, tids))
```

```python
    print(f"       {len(test):,} test users, "
          f"{sum(len(t) for _, t in test):,} candidates")
    return test


# ====================================================================
# 2. Album Enrichment
# ====================================================================

def enrich_tracks_with_albums(tracks, albums):
    enriched = {}
    stats = {"artist_filled": 0, "genres_added": 0, "tracks_enriched": 0}
    for tid, (alb, art, genres) in tracks.items():
        new_art = art
        new_genres = list(genres)
        if alb is not None and alb in albums:
            album_art, album_genres = albums[alb]
            if art is None and album_art is not None:
                new_art = album_art
                stats["artist_filled"] += 1
            track_genre_set = set(genres)
            added = 0
            for g in album_genres:
                if g not in track_genre_set:
                    new_genres.append(g)
                    track_genre_set.add(g)
                    added += 1
            if added > 0:
                stats["genres_added"] += added
                stats["tracks_enriched"] += 1
        enriched[tid] = (alb, new_art, new_genres)
    print(f"  Album Enrichment: {stats['artist_filled']:,} artists filled, "
          f"{stats['tracks_enriched']:,} tracks got new genres")
    return enriched


# ====================================================================
# 3. Feature Engineering
# ====================================================================

def compute_features(user_ratings, track_meta, uid, tid, mf_map=None,
                     mf_default=0.0, hierarchy=None):
    """Build feature vector for one (user, candidate-track) pair.

    If mf_map is provided, the ALS prediction for (uid, tid) is added
    to the feature dict as `mf_score` so strategies can use it as a
    natural signal alongside the heuristic features.

    If `hierarchy` is provided and contains (uid, tid), its lineage
    (album, artist, genres) overrides the track_meta lookup. This lets
    us use the per-test-row lineage from Week 6's testTrack_hierarchy.txt
    even when track_meta has missing or incomplete entries.
    """
    ratings = user_ratings.get(uid, {})
    if hierarchy is not None and (uid, tid) in hierarchy:
        alb_id, art_id, genre_ids = hierarchy[(uid, tid)]
    else:
        alb_id, art_id, genre_ids = track_meta.get(tid, (None, None, []))
    mf_score = mf_default if mf_map is None else mf_map.get((uid, tid), mf_default)
```

```python

    # Album score
    if alb_id is not None and alb_id in ratings:
        album_score, has_album = ratings[alb_id], 1
    else:
        album_score, has_album = 0, 0

    # Artist score
    if art_id is not None and art_id in ratings:
        artist_score, has_artist = ratings[art_id], 1
    else:
        artist_score, has_artist = 0, 0

    # Genre statistics
    genre_scores = [ratings[g] for g in genre_ids if g in ratings]
    n = len(genre_scores)
    if n > 0:
        g_max = max(genre_scores)
        g_min = min(genre_scores)
        g_mean = sum(genre_scores) / n
        g_var = sum((s - g_mean) ** 2 for s in genre_scores) / n
    else:
        g_max = g_min = 0
        g_mean = g_var = 0.0

    # Evidence count
    evidence_count = has_album + has_artist + (1 if n > 0 else 0)

    # Interaction (only when both signals present)
    album_artist_interact = (album_score * artist_score / 100.0
                             if (has_album and has_artist) else 0.0)

    return {
        "album_score": album_score,
        "has_album": has_album,
        "artist_score": artist_score,
        "has_artist": has_artist,
        "genre_count": n,
        "genre_max": g_max,
        "genre_min": g_min,
        "genre_mean": g_mean,
        "genre_var": g_var,
        "evidence_count": evidence_count,
        "album_artist_interact": album_artist_interact,
        "mf_score": mf_score,
    }


# ======================================================================
# 4. Scoring Strategies (all conservative v2 variants)
# ======================================================================

def strategy_v2_evidence(feats_list):
    """Original v2: has_album*album + has_artist*artist + genre_count*genre_mean/10
    Kaggle: 0.871"""
    return [
        f["has_album"] * f["album_score"]
        + f["has_artist"] * f["artist_score"]
        + f["genre_count"] * f["genre_mean"] / 10.0
```

```python
        for f in feats_list
    ]


def strategy_v2_mf_tiebreaker(feats_list, epsilon=0.001):
    """v2 heuristic with ALS as a pure tiebreaker.

    score = v2_score + epsilon * mf_score

    Preserves v2 ordering exactly; MF only breaks exact ties. Known
    floor: 0.871 (v2). Kaggle result: 0.875 (+0.004 over v2).
    """
    return [
        f["has_album"] * f["album_score"]
        + f["has_artist"] * f["artist_score"]
        + f["genre_count"] * f["genre_mean"] / 10.0
        + epsilon * f["mf_score"]
        for f in feats_list
    ]


def strategy_v2_mf_gated(feats_list):
    """Evidence-gated MF hybrid.

    The pure tiebreaker only activates on exact v2 ties. That's rare --
    mostly users with zero album/artist/genre overlap on all 6 candidates.
    This strategy lets MF have meaningful voice when v2 has LITTLE
    evidence, and recedes to a tiebreaker when v2 has STRONG evidence:

        evidence_count == 0 : weight = 5.0   (heuristic silent)
        evidence_count == 1 : weight = 0.2   (one signal, weak opinion)
        evidence_count == 2 : weight = 0.01  (two signals, small nudge)
        evidence_count >= 3 : weight = 0.001 (strong, tiebreak only)

    The 5.0 weight on silent candidates is enough to actually reorder
    them by ALS rather than ties. The smaller weights at higher evidence
    are bounded to stay below the minimum v2 delta, preserving the
    strong-signal ordering the way the tiebreaker does.
    """
    GATE = {0: 5.0, 1: 0.2, 2: 0.01}
    DEFAULT = 0.001
    scores = []
    for f in feats_list:
        base = (f["has_album"] * f["album_score"]
                + f["has_artist"] * f["artist_score"]
                + f["genre_count"] * f["genre_mean"] / 10.0)
        w = GATE.get(f["evidence_count"], DEFAULT)
        scores.append(base + w * f["mf_score"])
    return scores


# ======================================================================
# 4b. PySpark ALS trainer  (Week 11 sample code, adapted verbatim)
# ======================================================================
#
# Source: Lectures/Week11_04-13/supplemental_materials/
#         "PySpark Recommendation Code for the Final Project.py"
#
# The sample code reads the professor-provided pre-flattened CSV files
```

```python
# (userID,itemID,rating) with spark.read.csv directly -- no custom parser.
# We follow that pattern and produce a dict (uid, iid) -> prediction that
# v3's compute_features() can then use as a new feature.
# ====================================================================

def run_pyspark_als(rank=ALS_RANK, max_iter=ALS_MAX_ITER,
                    reg_param=ALS_REG_PARAM, seed=ALS_SEED):
    """Train PySpark ALS and return (train_pred_map, test_pred_map, rmse, mse).

    Uses the pre-flattened CSV files from Week 11's supplemental data
    (trainItem.data / testItem.data). Mirrors the Week 11 sample code
    configuration: rank=5, maxIter=5, regParam=0.01, nonnegative=True,
    coldStartStrategy="drop".

    Returns:
        train_pred_map: dict (uid, iid) -> ALS prediction, for every row
                        in the training set. Used to enrich v3's feature
                        table so the heuristic strategies can reference
                        an MF signal on observed tracks too.
        test_pred_map:  dict (uid, iid) -> ALS prediction for every row
                        in testItem.data (the Kaggle submission set).
        rmse, mse:      holdout metrics (HW7 sanity check discipline).
    """
    print("\n" + "=" * 60)
    print("  PYSPARK ALS TRAINING  (Week 11 sample code pattern)")
    print("=" * 60)
    print(f"  rank={rank}  maxIter={max_iter}  regParam={reg_param}")
    print(f"  Reading {SPARK_TRAIN_FILE}")
    print(f"  Reading {SPARK_TEST_FILE}")

    spark = (
        SparkSession.builder
        .master("local[*]")
        .appName("EE627_HW8_MF")
        .config("spark.sql.execution.arrow.pyspark.enabled", "true")
        .config("spark.driver.memory", "6g")
        .getOrCreate()
    )
    spark.sparkContext.setLogLevel("WARN")
    # Note: we can't use setCheckpointDir on Windows without winutils.exe.
    # Instead we rely on the -Xss64m stack bump (128x default) configured
    # above to survive the deep RDD lineage serialization at maxIter=20.
    print(f"  Spark {spark.version} ready")

    # --- Step 1: Load training data (sample code pattern) ---
    training = spark.read.csv(SPARK_TRAIN_FILE, header=False)
    training = (training
                .withColumnRenamed("_c0", "userID")
                .withColumnRenamed("_c1", "itemID")
                .withColumnRenamed("_c2", "rating"))
    training = (training
                .withColumn("userID", training["userID"].cast(IntegerType()))
                .withColumn("itemID", training["itemID"].cast(IntegerType()))
                .withColumn("rating", training["rating"].cast(FloatType())))
    print(f"  Training rows: {training.count():,}")

    # --- HW7 lesson: hold out a slice, report MSE before trusting it ---
    train_df, holdout_df = training.randomSplit([0.9, 0.1], seed=seed)

```

```python
    # --- Step 2: Configure ALS (sample code config) ---
    als = ALS(
        maxIter=max_iter,
        rank=rank,
        regParam=reg_param,
        userCol="userID",
        itemCol="itemID",
        ratingCol="rating",
        nonnegative=True,
        implicitPrefs=False,
        coldStartStrategy="drop",
        seed=seed,
    )

    # --- Step 3: Train on reduced, evaluate holdout, refit on full ---
    holdout_model = als.fit(train_df)
    holdout_preds = holdout_model.transform(holdout_df)
    evaluator = RegressionEvaluator(metricName="rmse",
                                    labelCol="rating",
                                    predictionCol="prediction")
    rmse = evaluator.evaluate(holdout_preds)
    mse = rmse ** 2
    print(f"  Holdout RMSE = {rmse:.4f}   MSE = {mse:.4f}")

    print("  Refitting on full training set ...")
    model = als.fit(training)

    # --- Step 4: Load testing data (sample code pattern) ---
    testing = spark.read.csv(SPARK_TEST_FILE, header=False)
    testing = (testing
               .withColumnRenamed("_c0", "userID")
               .withColumnRenamed("_c1", "itemID")
               .withColumnRenamed("_c2", "rating"))
    testing = (testing
               .withColumn("userID", testing["userID"].cast(IntegerType()))
               .withColumn("itemID", testing["itemID"].cast(IntegerType()))
               .withColumn("rating", testing["rating"].cast(FloatType())))
    print(f"  Testing rows: {testing.count():,}")

    # --- Step 5: Predict on both training and testing ---
    # We need training predictions too so v3's strategies (which compute
    # features over candidate tracks the user may or may not have rated)
    # can look up the MF signal regardless.
    test_predictions = model.transform(testing)
    train_predictions = model.transform(training)

    print("  Collecting ALS predictions ...")
    global_mean = training.agg({"rating": "avg"}).first()[0]
    print(f"  Training mean rating = {global_mean:.3f}")

    # Keep the full ordered list of test (uid, iid) pairs so the pure-MF
    # submission is guaranteed to have exactly 120k rows even when ALS drops
    # cold-start predictions.
    test_pairs = [(row["userID"], row["itemID"]) for row in testing.collect()]

    test_pred_map = {}
    for row in test_predictions.collect():
        pred = row["prediction"]
        if pred is None:
```

```python
            continue
        test_pred_map[(row["userID"], row["itemID"])] = float(pred)

    train_pred_map = {}
    for row in train_predictions.collect():
        pred = row["prediction"]
        if pred is None:
            continue
        train_pred_map[(row["userID"], row["itemID"])] = float(pred)

    print(f"  Test pairs: {len(test_pairs):,}   "
          f"ALS predictions: {len(test_pred_map):,}   "
          f"cold-start filled with global mean: "
          f"{len(test_pairs) - len(test_pred_map):,}")
    print(f"  Train predictions: {len(train_pred_map):,}")

    # --- Step 6: Save the pure-MF submission per sample code convention ---
    # Iterate the full test_pairs list so the submission has 120k rows even
    # if ALS dropped some predictions (cold-start users/items).
    pure_mf_path = os.path.join(OUTPUT_DIR, "submission_hw8_pyspark_mf.csv")
    print(f"  Writing pure-MF submission to {pure_mf_path}")
    from collections import defaultdict as _dd
    by_user = _dd(list)
    for uid, iid in test_pairs:
        pred = test_pred_map.get((uid, iid), global_mean)
        by_user[uid].append((iid, pred))
    pure_results = []
    for uid, items in by_user.items():
        ranked_items = sorted(items, key=lambda x: x[1], reverse=True)
        top3 = set(tid for tid, _ in ranked_items[:3])
        for iid, _ in items:
            pure_results.append((f"{uid}_{iid}", 1 if iid in top3 else 0))
    write_submission(pure_results, pure_mf_path)
    print(f"    {len(pure_results):,} rows written "
          f"(expected 120,000)")

    spark.stop()
    return train_pred_map, test_pred_map, rmse, mse, global_mean


# ====================================================================
# 5. Ranking & Submission
# ====================================================================

def rank_top3(scores, track_ids):
    paired = sorted(zip(scores, track_ids), key=lambda x: x[0], reverse=True)
    top3 = set(tid for _, tid in paired[:3])
    return {tid: (1 if tid in top3 else 0) for tid in track_ids}


def write_submission(results, path):
    with open(path, "w") as f:
        f.write("TrackID,Predictor\n")
        for key, label in results:
            f.write(f"{key},{label}\n")


def run_strategy(user_ratings, track_meta, test_users,
                 strategy_fn, out_path, strategy_name=None, mf_map=None,
```

```
                 hierarchy=None):
    name = strategy_name or strategy_fn.__name__
    print(f"\n>>> Running {name} ...")
    results = []
    for uid, candidates in test_users:
        feats = [compute_features(user_ratings, track_meta, uid, tid,
                                  mf_map=mf_map, hierarchy=hierarchy)
                 for tid in candidates]
        scores = strategy_fn(feats)
        recs = rank_top3(scores, candidates)
        for tid in candidates:
            results.append((f"{uid}_{tid}", recs[tid]))
    write_submission(results, out_path)
    ones = sum(v for _, v in results)
    print(f"    {len(results):,} predictions ({ones:,} rec, {len(results)-ones:,} don't)")
    print(f"    Saved -> {out_path}")
    return results


# ======================================================================
# 6. Validation & Grid Search
# ======================================================================

def build_validation_set(user_ratings, track_meta, fraction=0.1, seed=42):
    """Hold out tracks from 10% of users. Mimics test scenario."""
    rng = random.Random(seed)
    track_ids = set(track_meta.keys())
    all_uids = list(user_ratings.keys())
    rng.shuffle(all_uids)
    n_val = int(len(all_uids) * fraction)

    val_set = []
    val_user_held_items = {}
    for uid in all_uids[:n_val]:
        user_tracks = [iid for iid in user_ratings[uid] if iid in track_ids]
        if len(user_tracks) < 6:
            continue
        sample = rng.sample(user_tracks, 6)
        sample_ratings = {tid: user_ratings[uid][tid] for tid in sample}
        val_set.append((uid, sample, sample_ratings))
        val_user_held_items[uid] = set(sample)

    train_reduced = {}
    for uid, ratings in user_ratings.items():
        if uid in val_user_held_items:
            held = val_user_held_items[uid]
            train_reduced[uid] = {k: v for k, v in ratings.items()
                                  if k not in held}
        else:
            train_reduced[uid] = ratings

    print(f"  Validation: {len(val_set):,} users, {len(val_set)*6:,} candidates")
    return train_reduced, val_set


def compute_auc(val_set, user_ratings, track_meta, strategy_fn, mf_map=None,
                hierarchy=None):
    """AUC on validation: do we rank the true top-3 higher than bottom-3?"""
    correct = 0
```

```python
    total = 0
    for uid, items, true_ratings in val_set:
        feats = [compute_features(user_ratings, track_meta, uid, tid,
                                  mf_map=mf_map, hierarchy=hierarchy)
                 for tid in items]
        scores = strategy_fn(feats)
        rated = sorted(zip([true_ratings[iid] for iid in items], items),
                       reverse=True)
        positives = set(tid for _, tid in rated[:3])
        negatives = set(tid for _, tid in rated[3:])
        score_map = dict(zip(items, scores))
        for p in positives:
            for n in negatives:
                if score_map[p] > score_map[n]:
                    correct += 1
                elif score_map[p] == score_map[n]:
                    correct += 0.5
                total += 1
    return correct / total if total > 0 else 0.0


# ====================================================================
# 7. Main
# ====================================================================

class _Tee:
    """Duplicate stdout writes to a log file."""
    def __init__(self, *streams):
        self.streams = streams
    def write(self, data):
        for s in self.streams:
            s.write(data)
            s.flush()
    def flush(self):
        for s in self.streams:
            s.flush()


RESULTS_DIR = os.path.join(SCRIPT_DIR, "Results")
os.makedirs(RESULTS_DIR, exist_ok=True)
RESULTS_PATH = os.path.join(
    RESULTS_DIR,
    f"run_{datetime.now().strftime('%Y%m%d_%H%M%S')}.txt",
)


def main():
    log_fh = open(RESULTS_PATH, "w", encoding="utf-8")
    sys.stdout = _Tee(sys.__stdout__, log_fh)
    sys.stderr = _Tee(sys.__stderr__, log_fh)
    print("=" * 60)
    print("  EE627A Homework 8 - PySpark Matrix Factorization")
    print("  Jude Eschete")
    print("=" * 60)

    user_ratings = parse_training(TRAIN_FILE)
    track_meta = parse_tracks(TRACK_FILE)
    album_meta = parse_albums(ALBUM_FILE)
    test_users = parse_test(TEST_FILE)
```

```python
    hierarchy = parse_hierarchy(HIERARCHY_FILE)

    print("\n" + "=" * 60)
    print("  ENRICHING TRACKS")
    print("=" * 60)
    enriched_meta = enrich_tracks_with_albums(track_meta, album_meta)

    # ---- Validation ----
    print("\n" + "=" * 60)
    print("  VALIDATION & GRID SEARCH")
    print("=" * 60)
    train_reduced, val_set = build_validation_set(user_ratings, enriched_meta)

    # Baseline (+ same baseline with hierarchy lineage for test-time features)
    v2_auc = compute_auc(val_set, train_reduced, enriched_meta,
                         strategy_v2_evidence)
    print(f"\n  v2 baseline val AUC:              {v2_auc:.4f}")
    v2_hier_auc = compute_auc(val_set, train_reduced, enriched_meta,
                              strategy_v2_evidence, hierarchy=hierarchy)
    print(f"  v2 baseline val AUC (+hierarchy): {v2_hier_auc:.4f}")

    # ---- PySpark ALS training (HW8 Part 1 core) ----
    # Run ALS on the Week-11 pre-flattened CSVs using the sample code
    # pattern. Also writes submission_hw8_pyspark_mf.csv (pure MF).
    train_pred_map, test_pred_map, holdout_rmse, holdout_mse, _mf_mean = \
        run_pyspark_als()

    # Sanity-check both hybrids against the v2 floor locally.
    tiebreaker_val_auc = compute_auc(
        val_set, train_reduced, enriched_meta,
        strategy_v2_mf_tiebreaker,
        mf_map=train_pred_map, hierarchy=hierarchy,
    )
    gated_val_auc = compute_auc(
        val_set, train_reduced, enriched_meta,
        strategy_v2_mf_gated,
        mf_map=train_pred_map, hierarchy=hierarchy,
    )
    print(f"\n  v2+MF tiebreaker val AUC (+hier): {tiebreaker_val_auc:.4f}")
    print(f"  v2+MF evidence-gated val AUC (+hier): {gated_val_auc:.4f}")

    # ---- Generate hybrid submissions ----
    print("\n" + "=" * 60)
    print("  GENERATING HYBRID SUBMISSIONS")
    print("=" * 60)
    run_strategy(
        user_ratings, enriched_meta, test_users,
        strategy_v2_mf_tiebreaker,
        os.path.join(OUTPUT_DIR, "submission_hw8_hybrid.csv"),
        strategy_name="v2 + MF tiebreaker (+hierarchy)",
        mf_map=test_pred_map, hierarchy=hierarchy,
    )
    run_strategy(
        user_ratings, enriched_meta, test_users,
        strategy_v2_mf_gated,
        os.path.join(OUTPUT_DIR, "submission_hw8_hybrid_gated.csv"),
        strategy_name="v2 + MF evidence-gated (+hierarchy)",
        mf_map=test_pred_map, hierarchy=hierarchy,
    )
```

```python

    # ---- Summary ----
    print("\n" + "=" * 60)
    print("  RESULTS")
    print("=" * 60)
    print(f"  v2 baseline val AUC:                  {v2_auc:.4f}")
    print(f"  v2 baseline +hier val AUC:            {v2_hier_auc:.4f}")
    print(f"  v2+MF tiebreaker (+hier) val AUC:     {tiebreaker_val_auc:.4f}")
    print(f"  v2+MF evidence-gated (+hier) val AUC: {gated_val_auc:.4f}")
    print(f"  ALS holdout RMSE:                     {holdout_rmse:.4f}   "
          f"MSE: {holdout_mse:.4f}  "
          f"(rank={ALS_RANK}, maxIter={ALS_MAX_ITER}, regParam={ALS_REG_PARAM})")
    print()
    print("  Files to upload for HW8 Part 1:")
    print(f"    submission_hw8_pyspark_mf.csv       <-- pure PySpark MF")
    print(f"    submission_hw8_hybrid.csv           <-- v2 + MF tiebreaker")
    print(f"    submission_hw8_hybrid_gated.csv     <-- v2 + MF evidence-gated")
    print(f"\n  Full run log written to: {RESULTS_PATH}")
    print("\nDone.")
    log_fh.close()


def _log_crash(exc):
    """Write a clean, timestamped crash report next to Results/."""
    err_path = os.path.join(
        RESULTS_DIR,
        f"error_{datetime.now().strftime('%Y%m%d_%H%M%S')}.log",
    )
    with open(err_path, "w", encoding="utf-8") as fh:
        fh.write("=" * 60 + "\n")
        fh.write(f"  CRASH: {type(exc).__name__}\n")
        fh.write(f"  When:  {datetime.now().isoformat()}\n")
        fh.write("=" * 60 + "\n\n")
        fh.write(f"{type(exc).__name__}: {exc}\n\n")
        fh.write("Traceback:\n")
        fh.write("-" * 60 + "\n")
        traceback.print_exc(file=fh)
        fh.write("\n" + "-" * 60 + "\n")
    # Also append a one-line summary to a rolling error index.
    index_path = os.path.join(RESULTS_DIR, "errors_index.log")
    with open(index_path, "a", encoding="utf-8") as fh:
        fh.write(
            f"{datetime.now().isoformat()}  "
            f"{type(exc).__name__}: {str(exc).splitlines()[0][:200]}  "
            f"-> {os.path.basename(err_path)}\n"
        )
    return err_path


if __name__ == "__main__":
    try:
        main()
    except Exception as exc:
        err_path = _log_crash(exc)
        print(f"\n[!] Crashed: {type(exc).__name__}: {exc}", file=sys.__stderr__)
        print(f"[!] Full traceback written to: {err_path}", file=sys.__stderr__)
        print(f"[!] Rolling index: {os.path.join(RESULTS_DIR, 'errors_index.log')}",
              file=sys.__stderr__)
        sys.exit(1)
```

Listing 1: EE627_Homework8_Eschete_Part1.py — PySpark MF pipeline for the final project

```python
"""
EE627A Homework 8 - Part 2: PySpark ALS Parameter Sweeps on re_u.data
Jude Eschete

Three experiments per the HW8 Part 2 instructions:
  1. Fix maxIter=20. Vary rank in {5, 7, 10, 20}. Measure MSE.
  2. Fix rank=20. Vary maxIter in {2, 5, 10, 20}. Measure MSE.
  3. Fix rank=20, maxIter=20. Vary data size in
     {2000, 5000, 10000, 20000, 50000, 100000}. Measure MSE.

Data: re_u.data (MovieLens-100k style)
  Format: userID,itemID,rating    (rating in 1-5, 100000 rows total)
  Taken from Week 11 supplemental materials, copied into Data/.

Per the instructions, data slices for experiment 3 are built with
`sc.textFile(...).take(n)` (first n rows), then converted to DataFrame,
mirroring the code fragment in the assignment.

Outputs:
  - Results/part2_run_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.txt   : full teed stdout log
  - Results/part2_metrics_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.csv : one row per ALS run with
      experiment, rank, maxIter, data_size, holdout_rmse, holdout_mse
  - Results/error_YYYYMMDD_HHMMSS.log       : crash report on failure
"""

import os
import sys
import csv
import traceback
from datetime import datetime

# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
# Environment setup (same pattern as Part 1).
# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
JAVA_HOME_CANDIDATES = [
    r"C:\Program Files\Eclipse Adoptium\jdk-17.0.18.8-hotspot",
    r"C:\Program Files\Eclipse Adoptium\jdk-25.0.2.10-hotspot",
]
for _candidate in JAVA_HOME_CANDIDATES:
    if os.path.isdir(_candidate):
        os.environ["JAVA_HOME"] = _candidate
        os.environ["PATH"] = _candidate + r"\bin;" + os.environ["PATH"]
        break

os.environ.setdefault("PYARROW_IGNORE_TIMEZONE", "1")
os.environ["PYSPARK_PYTHON"] = sys.executable
os.environ["PYSPARK_DRIVER_PYTHON"] = sys.executable

_JAVA_OPTS = " ".join([
    "-XX:+IgnoreUnrecognizedVMOptions",
    "-Djava.security.manager=allow",
    "-Xss64m",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.lang=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.lang.invoke=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.lang.reflect=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.io=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.net=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.nio=ALL-UNNAMED",
```

```python
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.util=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.util.concurrent=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/java.util.concurrent.atomic=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/sun.nio.ch=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/sun.nio.cs=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/sun.security.action=ALL-UNNAMED",
    "--add-opens=java.base/sun.util.calendar=ALL-UNNAMED",
])
os.environ["PYSPARK_SUBMIT_ARGS"] = f'--driver-java-options "{_JAVA_OPTS}" pyspark-shell'

from pyspark.sql import SparkSession, Row
from pyspark.sql.types import StructType, StructField, IntegerType, FloatType
from pyspark.ml.recommendation import ALS
from pyspark.ml.evaluation import RegressionEvaluator


# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
# Config
# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
SCRIPT_DIR = os.path.dirname(os.path.abspath(__file__))
DATA_FILE = os.path.join(SCRIPT_DIR, "Data", "re_u.data")

RESULTS_DIR = os.path.join(SCRIPT_DIR, "Results")
os.makedirs(RESULTS_DIR, exist_ok=True)
TIMESTAMP = datetime.now().strftime("%Y%m%d_%H%M%S")
RESULTS_PATH = os.path.join(RESULTS_DIR, f"part2_run_{TIMESTAMP}.txt")
METRICS_CSV = os.path.join(RESULTS_DIR, f"part2_metrics_{TIMESTAMP}.csv")

SEED = 42
HOLDOUT_FRACTION = 0.2  # 80/20 split per run

# Experiment 1: fix maxIter, sweep rank
EXP1_MAX_ITER = 20
EXP1_RANKS = [5, 7, 10, 20]

# Experiment 2: fix rank, sweep maxIter
EXP2_RANK = 20
EXP2_MAX_ITERS = [2, 5, 10, 20]

# Experiment 3: fix rank + maxIter, sweep data size
EXP3_RANK = 20
EXP3_MAX_ITER = 20
EXP3_SIZES = [2000, 5000, 10000, 20000, 50000, 100000]


class _Tee:
    """Duplicate stdout/stderr writes to a log file."""
    def __init__(self, *streams):
        self.streams = streams
    def write(self, data):
        for s in self.streams:
            s.write(data)
            s.flush()
    def flush(self):
        for s in self.streams:
            s.flush()


# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
```

```python
# Data loading
# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
RATING_SCHEMA = StructType([
    StructField("userID", IntegerType(), False),
    StructField("itemID", IntegerType(), False),
    StructField("rating", FloatType(), False),
])


def load_full(spark):
    """Load the entire re_u.data file as a DataFrame."""
    df = spark.read.csv(DATA_FILE, header=False, schema=StructType([
        StructField("userID", IntegerType(), True),
        StructField("itemID", IntegerType(), True),
        StructField("rating", FloatType(), True),
    ]))
    return df


def load_first_n(spark, n):
    """Take the first n rows of re_u.data per the HW8 instructions example:

        data = sc.textFile("re_u.data")
        pData = data.take(n)

    Then convert the resulting list back into a DataFrame for ALS.
    """
    lines = spark.sparkContext.textFile(DATA_FILE).take(n)
    rows = []
    for line in lines:
        parts = line.strip().split(",")
        if len(parts) != 3:
            continue
        rows.append(Row(userID=int(parts[0]),
                        itemID=int(parts[1]),
                        rating=float(parts[2])))
    return spark.createDataFrame(rows, schema=RATING_SCHEMA)


# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
# Core experiment runner
# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
def run_als(df, rank, max_iter, label, metrics_writer):
    """Train ALS with the given config, return holdout RMSE/MSE.

    Splits df 80/20 for honest held-out evaluation. Uses the Week 11
    sample code ALS configuration (nonnegative, coldStart=drop).
    """
    train_df, holdout_df = df.randomSplit(
        [1.0 - HOLDOUT_FRACTION, HOLDOUT_FRACTION], seed=SEED
    )

    als = ALS(
        rank=rank,
        maxIter=max_iter,
        regParam=0.05,
        userCol="userID",
        itemCol="itemID",
        ratingCol="rating",
```

```
        nonnegative=True,
        implicitPrefs=False,
        coldStartStrategy="drop",
        seed=SEED,
    )

    model = als.fit(train_df)
    preds = model.transform(holdout_df)
    evaluator = RegressionEvaluator(metricName="rmse",
                                    labelCol="rating",
                                    predictionCol="prediction")
    rmse = evaluator.evaluate(preds)
    mse = rmse ** 2

    total_rows = df.count()
    train_rows = train_df.count()
    holdout_rows = holdout_df.count()
    print(f"    rank={rank:<3d} maxIter={max_iter:<3d} "
          f"size={total_rows:<7d} train={train_rows:<6d} "
          f"holdout={holdout_rows:<6d} "
          f"RMSE={rmse:.4f}   MSE={mse:.4f}")

    metrics_writer.writerow({
        "experiment": label,
        "rank": rank,
        "maxIter": max_iter,
        "data_size": total_rows,
        "train_rows": train_rows,
        "holdout_rows": holdout_rows,
        "holdout_rmse": f"{rmse:.6f}",
        "holdout_mse": f"{mse:.6f}",
    })
    return rmse, mse


def experiment_rank_sweep(spark, full_df, metrics_writer):
    print("\n" + "=" * 60)
    print("  EXPERIMENT 1: rank sweep")
    print(f"  Fixed maxIter={EXP1_MAX_ITER}")
    print(f"  Varying rank in {EXP1_RANKS}")
    print("=" * 60)
    results = []
    for rank in EXP1_RANKS:
        rmse, mse = run_als(full_df, rank=rank, max_iter=EXP1_MAX_ITER,
                            label="exp1_rank_sweep",
                            metrics_writer=metrics_writer)
        results.append((rank, rmse, mse))
    return results


def experiment_iter_sweep(spark, full_df, metrics_writer):
    print("\n" + "=" * 60)
    print("  EXPERIMENT 2: maxIter sweep")
    print(f"  Fixed rank={EXP2_RANK}")
    print(f"  Varying maxIter in {EXP2_MAX_ITERS}")
    print("=" * 60)
    results = []
    for max_iter in EXP2_MAX_ITERS:
        rmse, mse = run_als(full_df, rank=EXP2_RANK, max_iter=max_iter,
```

```
                            label="exp2_maxIter_sweep",
                            metrics_writer=metrics_writer)
        results.append((max_iter, rmse, mse))
    return results


def experiment_size_sweep(spark, metrics_writer):
    print("\n" + "=" * 60)
    print("  EXPERIMENT 3: data size sweep")
    print(f"  Fixed rank={EXP3_RANK}, maxIter={EXP3_MAX_ITER}")
    print(f"  Varying size in {EXP3_SIZES}")
    print("  (using sc.textFile.take(n) per the HW8 instructions)")
    print("=" * 60)
    results = []
    for size in EXP3_SIZES:
        df = load_first_n(spark, size)
        rmse, mse = run_als(df, rank=EXP3_RANK, max_iter=EXP3_MAX_ITER,
                            label="exp3_size_sweep",
                            metrics_writer=metrics_writer)
        results.append((size, rmse, mse))
    return results


def summarize(exp1, exp2, exp3):
    def mse_range(results):
        mses = [r[2] for r in results]
        return max(mses) - min(mses), min(mses), max(mses)

    e1_delta, e1_min, e1_max = mse_range(exp1)
    e2_delta, e2_min, e2_max = mse_range(exp2)
    e3_delta, e3_min, e3_max = mse_range(exp3)

    print("\n" + "=" * 60)
    print("  SUMMARY: which factor moves MSE the most?")
    print("=" * 60)
    print(f"  Exp 1 (rank sweep):     MSE range = {e1_delta:.4f}   "
          f"[{e1_min:.4f} .. {e1_max:.4f}]")
    print(f"  Exp 2 (maxIter sweep):  MSE range = {e2_delta:.4f}   "
          f"[{e2_min:.4f} .. {e2_max:.4f}]")
    print(f"  Exp 3 (data size):      MSE range = {e3_delta:.4f}   "
          f"[{e3_min:.4f} .. {e3_max:.4f}]")

    ranked = sorted(
        [("rank", e1_delta), ("maxIter", e2_delta), ("data size", e3_delta)],
        key=lambda x: x[1], reverse=True,
    )
    print("\n  Most impactful -> least impactful:")
    for i, (name, delta) in enumerate(ranked, start=1):
        print(f"    {i}. {name:10s}   delta_MSE = {delta:.4f}")


# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
# Main
# ---------------------------------------------------------------------------
def main():
    log_fh = open(RESULTS_PATH, "w", encoding="utf-8")
    sys.stdout = _Tee(sys.__stdout__, log_fh)
    sys.stderr = _Tee(sys.__stderr__, log_fh)

```

```python
    print("=" * 60)
    print("  EE627A Homework 8 - PART 2: Parameter Sweeps")
    print("  Jude Eschete")
    print(f"  Run started: {datetime.now().isoformat()}")
    print("=" * 60)
    print(f"  Data file: {DATA_FILE}")
    print(f"  Results log: {RESULTS_PATH}")
    print(f"  Metrics CSV: {METRICS_CSV}")

    spark = (
        SparkSession.builder
        .master("local[*]")
        .appName("EE627_HW8_Part2")
        .config("spark.sql.execution.arrow.pyspark.enabled", "true")
        .config("spark.driver.memory", "6g")
        .getOrCreate()
    )
    spark.sparkContext.setLogLevel("WARN")
    print(f"  Spark {spark.version} ready")

    full_df = load_full(spark)
    print(f"  Loaded {full_df.count():,} rows from re_u.data")
    full_df.show(5)

    metrics_fh = open(METRICS_CSV, "w", encoding="utf-8", newline="")
    metrics_writer = csv.DictWriter(
        metrics_fh,
        fieldnames=[
            "experiment", "rank", "maxIter", "data_size",
            "train_rows", "holdout_rows",
            "holdout_rmse", "holdout_mse",
        ],
    )
    metrics_writer.writeheader()

    exp1 = experiment_rank_sweep(spark, full_df, metrics_writer)
    exp2 = experiment_iter_sweep(spark, full_df, metrics_writer)
    exp3 = experiment_size_sweep(spark, metrics_writer)

    metrics_fh.close()

    summarize(exp1, exp2, exp3)

    print(f"\n  Run log:     {RESULTS_PATH}")
    print(f"  Metrics CSV: {METRICS_CSV}")
    print("\nDone.")
    log_fh.close()
    spark.stop()


def _log_crash(exc):
    err_path = os.path.join(
        RESULTS_DIR,
        f"part2_error_{datetime.now().strftime('%Y%m%d_%H%M%S')}.log",
    )
    with open(err_path, "w", encoding="utf-8") as fh:
        fh.write("=" * 60 + "\n")
        fh.write(f"  CRASH: {type(exc).__name__}  (Part 2)\n")
        fh.write(f"  When:  {datetime.now().isoformat()}\n")
```

```
        fh.write("=" * 60 + "\n\n")
        fh.write(f"{type(exc).__name__}: {exc}\n\n")
        fh.write("Traceback:\n")
        fh.write("-" * 60 + "\n")
        traceback.print_exc(file=fh)
        fh.write("\n" + "-" * 60 + "\n")
    index_path = os.path.join(RESULTS_DIR, "errors_index.log")
    with open(index_path, "a", encoding="utf-8") as fh:
        fh.write(
            f"{datetime.now().isoformat()}  PART2  "
            f"{type(exc).__name__}: {str(exc).splitlines()[0][:200]}  "
            f"-> {os.path.basename(err_path)}\n"
        )
    return err_path


if __name__ == "__main__":
    try:
        main()
    except Exception as exc:
        err_path = _log_crash(exc)
        print(f"\n[!] Part 2 crashed: {type(exc).__name__}: {exc}",
              file=sys.__stderr__)
        print(f"[!] Full traceback written to: {err_path}",
              file=sys.__stderr__)
        sys.exit(1)
```

Listing 2: EE627_Homework8_Eschete_Part2.py — Parameter sweep driver for re_u.data

6 Appendix: Console Output

```
============================================================
  EE627A Homework 8 - PySpark Matrix Factorization
  Jude Eschete
============================================================
[1/4] Loading training data ...
       49,204 users, 12,403,575 ratings
[2/4] Loading track metadata ...
       224,041 tracks
[3/4] Loading album metadata ...
       52,829 albums
[4/4] Loading test data ...
       20,000 test users, 120,000 candidates
[hier] Loading test-track hierarchy ...
       120,000 test-track hierarchy entries

============================================================
  ENRICHING TRACKS
============================================================
  Album Enrichment: 8,134 artists filled, 62,060 tracks got new genres

============================================================
  VALIDATION & GRID SEARCH
============================================================
  Validation: 2,562 users, 15,372 candidates

  v2 baseline val AUC:              0.6692
  v2 baseline val AUC (+hierarchy): 0.6692

============================================================
  PYSPARK ALS TRAINING  (Week 11 sample code pattern)
============================================================
  rank=20  maxIter=20  regParam=0.05
  Reading d:\judee\Google Drive\School\Classes\EE627\Homework\Homework 8\Data\trainItem.data
  Reading d:\judee\Google Drive\School\Classes\EE627\Homework\Homework 8\Data\testItem.data
  Spark 4.1.1 ready
  Training rows: 12,403,575
  Holdout RMSE = 28.7487   MSE = 826.4860
  Refitting on full training set ...
  Testing rows: 120,000
  Collecting ALS predictions ...
  Training mean rating = 49.771
  Test pairs: 120,000   ALS predictions: 119,974   cold-start filled with global mean: 26
  Train predictions: 12,403,575
  Writing pure-MF submission to d:\judee\Google Drive\School\Classes\EE627\Homework\Homework 8\
    ↪ submission_hw8_pyspark_mf.csv
    120,000 rows written (expected 120,000)

  v2+MF tiebreaker val AUC (+hier): 0.7029
  v2+MF evidence-gated val AUC (+hier): 0.6934

============================================================
  GENERATING HYBRID SUBMISSIONS
============================================================

>>> Running v2 + MF tiebreaker (+hierarchy) ...
    120,000 predictions (60,000 rec, 60,000 don't)
```

```
    Saved -> d:\judee\Google Drive\School\Classes\EE627\Homework\Homework 8\submission_hw8_hybrid.csv

>>> Running v2 + MF evidence-gated (+hierarchy) ...
    120,000 predictions (60,000 rec, 60,000 don't)
    Saved -> d:\judee\Google Drive\School\Classes\EE627\Homework\Homework 8\submission_hw8_hybrid_gated.csv

============================================================
  RESULTS
============================================================
  v2 baseline val AUC:                  0.6692
  v2 baseline +hier val AUC:            0.6692
  v2+MF tiebreaker (+hier) val AUC:     0.7029
  v2+MF evidence-gated (+hier) val AUC: 0.6934
  ALS holdout RMSE:                     28.7487   MSE: 826.4860  (rank=20, maxIter=20, regParam=0.05)

  Files to upload for HW8 Part 1:
    submission_hw8_pyspark_mf.csv       <-- pure PySpark MF
    submission_hw8_hybrid.csv           <-- v2 + MF tiebreaker
    submission_hw8_hybrid_gated.csv     <-- v2 + MF evidence-gated

  Full run log written to: d:\judee\Google Drive\School\Classes\EE627\Homework\Homework 8\Results\
    ↪ run_20260415_184902.txt

Done.
```

Listing 3: Part 1 run log

```
============================================================
  EE627A Homework 8 - PART 2: Parameter Sweeps
  Jude Eschete
  Run started: 2026-04-15T19:17:28.204286
============================================================
  Data file: d:\judee\Google Drive\School\Classes\EE627\Homework\Homework 8\Data\re_u.data
  Results log: d:\judee\Google Drive\School\Classes\EE627\Homework\Homework 8\Results\
     ↪ part2_run_20260415_191728.txt
  Metrics CSV: d:\judee\Google Drive\School\Classes\EE627\Homework\Homework 8\Results\
     ↪ part2_metrics_20260415_191728.csv
  Spark 4.1.1 ready
  Loaded 100,000 rows from re_u.data
+------+------+------+
|userID|itemID|rating|
+------+------+------+
|   196|   242|   3.0|
|   186|   302|   3.0|
|    22|   377|   1.0|
|   244|    51|   2.0|
|   166|   346|   1.0|
+------+------+------+
only showing top 5 rows

============================================================
  EXPERIMENT 1: rank sweep
  Fixed maxIter=20
  Varying rank in [5, 7, 10, 20]
============================================================
    rank=5   maxIter=20  size=100000  train=79901  holdout=20099  RMSE=0.9234   MSE=0.8527
    rank=7   maxIter=20  size=100000  train=79901  holdout=20099  RMSE=0.9286   MSE=0.8624
    rank=10  maxIter=20  size=100000  train=79901  holdout=20099  RMSE=0.9417   MSE=0.8867
    rank=20  maxIter=20  size=100000  train=79901  holdout=20099  RMSE=0.9507   MSE=0.9038

============================================================
  EXPERIMENT 2: maxIter sweep
  Fixed rank=20
  Varying maxIter in [2, 5, 10, 20]
============================================================
    rank=20  maxIter=2   size=100000  train=79901  holdout=20099  RMSE=0.9728   MSE=0.9463
    rank=20  maxIter=5   size=100000  train=79901  holdout=20099  RMSE=0.9379   MSE=0.8797
    rank=20  maxIter=10  size=100000  train=79901  holdout=20099  RMSE=0.9458   MSE=0.8946
    rank=20  maxIter=20  size=100000  train=79901  holdout=20099  RMSE=0.9507   MSE=0.9038

============================================================
  EXPERIMENT 3: data size sweep
  Fixed rank=20, maxIter=20
  Varying size in [2000, 5000, 10000, 20000, 50000, 100000]
  (using sc.textFile.take(n) per the HW8 instructions)
============================================================
    rank=20  maxIter=20  size=2000    train=1591   holdout=409    RMSE=1.5395   MSE=2.3701
    rank=20  maxIter=20  size=5000    train=4005   holdout=995    RMSE=1.2822   MSE=1.6440
    rank=20  maxIter=20  size=10000   train=7996   holdout=2004   RMSE=1.1935   MSE=1.4244
    rank=20  maxIter=20  size=20000   train=15965  holdout=4035   RMSE=1.1203   MSE=1.2550
    rank=20  maxIter=20  size=50000   train=40104  holdout=9896   RMSE=1.0365   MSE=1.0743
    rank=20  maxIter=20  size=100000  train=80037  holdout=19963  RMSE=0.9459   MSE=0.8946

============================================================
  SUMMARY: which factor moves MSE the most?
```

```
============================================================
  Exp 1 (rank sweep):     MSE range = 0.0512   [0.8527 .. 0.9038]
  Exp 2 (maxIter sweep):  MSE range = 0.0666   [0.8797 .. 0.9463]
  Exp 3 (data size):      MSE range = 1.4755   [0.8946 .. 2.3701]

  Most impactful -> least impactful:
    1. data size    delta_MSE = 1.4755
    2. maxIter      delta_MSE = 0.0666
    3. rank         delta_MSE = 0.0512

  Run log:     d:\judee\Google Drive\School\Classes\EE627\Homework\Homework 8\Results\part2_run_20260415_191728.txt
  Metrics CSV: d:\judee\Google Drive\School\Classes\EE627\Homework\Homework 8\Results\part2_metrics_20260415_191728.csv

Done.
```

Listing 4: Part 2 run log